

RAÍCES

Additional Resources

How to Read and Study the Bible: A Guide for New Believers

Reading the Bible is one of the spiritual disciplines you already learned about in your RAÍCES journey. This guide gives you a simple method to read it in a way that truly transforms your life, not just to collect information.

2 Timothy 3:16-17 (NLT): "All Scripture is inspired by God and is useful to teach us what is true and to make us realize what is wrong in our lives. It corrects us when we are wrong and teaches us to do what is right. God uses it to prepare and equip his people to do every good work."

Why should we read the Bible?

- To know God.
- To strengthen your faith.
- To know His will for your life.
- To correct the way you live.
- To grow spiritually.
- To learn to obey God.

Romans 10:17 (NLT): "So faith comes from hearing, that is, hearing the Good News about Christ."

Question to reflect on: Am I reading the Bible only to gain knowledge, or am I letting God transform my life through it?

How should we read the Bible?

Read with prayer

Ask the Holy Spirit to help you understand and apply what you read.

Psalms 119:18 (NLT): "Open my eyes to see the wonderful truths in your instructions."

Read with attention

It's not about reading many chapters quickly — it's better to read a little and truly understand it.

Read in context

Notice what comes before and after the verse. Consider who wrote it, who it was written to, and what the situation was at the time.

A simple method: O-I-A

Observe

What does the text say? Look for key words, people, actions, promises, commands, and warnings.

Interpret

What does it mean? Try to understand what the author intended to communicate, not what you'd like it to say.

Apply

How can I put this into practice? Ask yourself what you need to change, obey, start doing, believe, or let go of.

James 1:22 (NLT): *"But don't just listen to God's word. You must do what it says. Otherwise, you are only fooling yourselves."*

Where can a new believer start?

- John — to get to know Jesus.
- Mark — to learn about His life and ministry.
- Acts — to see the birth and growth of the Church.
- Ephesians — to understand your identity in Christ.
- Philippians — to learn about joy and the Christian life.
- Psalms — to learn how to relate to God through prayer and worship.

What do you need to study the Bible?

- A Bible (printed or on your phone).
- Prayer.
- A notebook and something to write with.
- A set time in your day.
- A willingness to obey what you learn.

A simple practice

READ → REFLECT → WRITE → PRAY → APPLY

Example: you read Philippians 4:13. What did you learn? That Christ gives you strength. What should you do with that? Trust Him in whatever situation you're facing right now.

Philippians 4:13 (NLT): *"For I can do everything through Christ, who gives me strength."*

Important principles

- Don't read just to finish the chapter; read to learn something.
- Don't look only for information; look for transformation.
- Don't interpret the Bible only based on how you feel — first ask what the text actually says.
- Don't give up when you don't understand something. Write it down, keep studying, and ask a mature believer or your mentor.

THE MAIN TRUTH The Bible wasn't given only to be read, but to be believed, obeyed, and lived out.

Final question: What change does God want to bring about in my life through what I learned today from His Word?